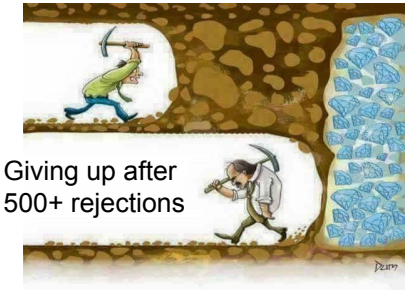
# 🥸 Imposter Syndrome

- **The Comparison Trap**: Seeing a page full of “I’m thrilled to announce...” on LinkedIn while you just got your 100th rejection is the best way to feel like a fraud.
- **A “Safe Space” to Fail**: This DeCal is designed for you to be a beginner. Not knowing the answer isn’t a weakness, it’s the baseline.
- **Growth = Discomfort**: If you don’t feel like an imposter, you aren’t pushing yourself into the scenarios that make you grow.
- **The Reality**: Even after internships at your “dream” companies, that voice doesn’t go away - you just get better at ignoring it.

# 🌱 My Advice & “Real World” Mindset

- **Rejection ≠ Failure**: Rejection is normal and **should be expected**. Every “Unfortunately…” is one step closer to a “Congratulations!”
- **Consistency > Intensity**: Success isn’t from a single 100-hour week; it’s about the *daily habits* that compound over years.
- **Don’t Compare Chapters**: You might be in your “Chapter 2”. Don’t compare yourself to someone else’s “Chapter 15”.
- **The “Say Yes” Rule**: Opportunities are *always* going to arrive before you feel “ready” - say yes first, then figure it out later.



what i think a scary **internship** will be like

what it's actually like

# 🤷 What are your options with Data Science?

**Banking & Finance** → quantitative research, risk analysis, fintech

**Software Engineering** → backend, ML systems, data infrastructure

**Product Management** → data-driven product design & strategy

**Consulting** → AI, data, strategy

**Research** → AI, healthcare, energy, academia

**Public Sector & Nonprofits** → data policy, urban planning, social impact

**Healthcare & Biotech** → clinical data, genomics, medical imaging, drug discovery

**E-commerce & Retail** → recommendation systems, pricing, supply chain optimization

**Climate & Energy** → EV analytics, renewable energy forecasting, environmental science

**Sports & Media** → performance analytics, audience data, content recommendation

**Entrepreneurship & Startups** → building data-driven products, founding your own venture, go-to-market/growth

# 👑 My Job Boards Tier List

**Jobright**: Best new app. Always has new job postings that you can find *within minutes* of being published. Mobile app is great!

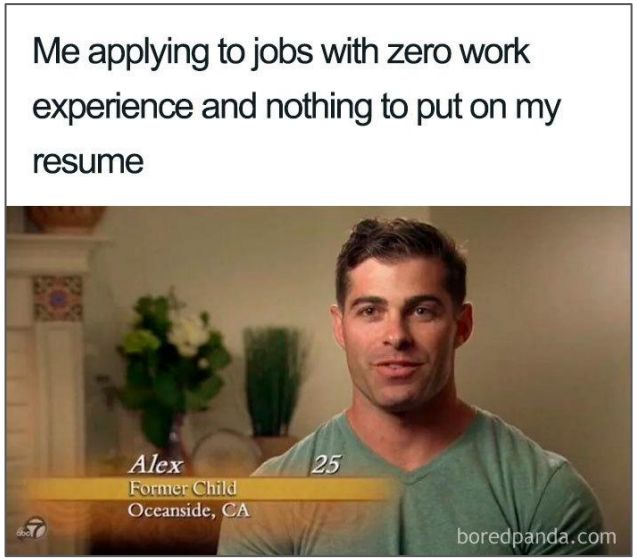
**Simplify**: Mostly used for their resume autofill Chrome extension, also has a job board. Also what powers the “PittCSC Internships” Github.

**Handshake**: Your advantage as a Berkeley student. Many jobs are part of the “Berkeley Collection” which means only Berkeley students can see them.

**Wellfound**: A job board specifically for startups.

# ✏️ Tracking Your Progress

- Great idea to keep track of where you apply & when
  - Know if you should keep waiting or send an email
- **Extras**: Write down notes about your interviewers as you go, so you can mention speaking with them in later rounds!
- Link to below spreadsheet: [tinyurl.com/dssemploy](tinyurl.com/dssemploy)
  - Make a copy for yourself!




| Date | Platform | Status | Type | Job Title | Company | Location | Cover Letter | Referral | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12/31/2023 | Simplify | Applied | Product Management | Example Position | Salesforce | San Francisco, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | LinkedIn | Denied | Data Science/Analytics | Example Position | AirBnb | Los Angeles, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Indeed | OA | Business Analyst | Example Position | Rockstar Games | New York, NY | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Handshake | Interview | Finance | Example Position | General Motors | Boston, MA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Wellfound | Final Round | Quant | Example Position | Dropbox | San Francisco, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Other | Offer | Consulting | Example Position | PayPal | New York, NY | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Glassdoor | Accepted | SWE | Example Position | Atlassian | San Francisco, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Simplify | TO APPLY | Product Management | Example Position | LinkedIn | Sunnyvale, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | LinkedIn | Applied | Data Science/Analytics | Example Position | Figma | San Francisco, CA | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12/31/2023 | Indeed | Denied | Business Analyst | Example Position | JP Morgan Chase & Co | Chicago, IL | ☐ | ☐ | |

# 🐻 Take Advantage of Being a Bear

- **This DeCal!**: Doing a full, end-to-end project is a great way to show proof of your skills to any employer.
- **Data Discovery Program**: High-impact research in academic, government, nonprofit and *industry* projects. Industry projects (projects with companies) are like unpaid internships!
- **Berkeley SkyDeck Internships**: Get an internship with a startup to start your career! Great way to get your first experience.
- **Clubs**: Joining *any* club is a great way to expand your network and make friends! Clubs like Data Science Undergraduate Association and Computer Science Undergraduate Association are open to all!
- **Cal Alumni Network**: Reach out to Berkeley Alumni on LinkedIn! People are very willing to have a quick chat and give referrals.

# ❓ FAQ

**Is AI going to take our jobs?**
Maybe, but not yet. Human oversight is needed for final decision-making and *ethical reasoning*.

**What classes are most important for Data Science?**
Data 100, CS 61B, Data 101

**Do I have to write cover letters?**
No. Recruiters barely have time to go through applications, much less AI-generated cover letters.

**How much does GPA matter?**
Not as much as you think. 3.0+ keeps you in the application pool, 3.3+ should go on your resume, 3.5-3.7 is “good” and 3.8+ is “great”